

Question Responses Air Operations Permit Writer

November 24, 2025

0.1 Objective

To provide program management and project analyses in support of evidence-based policy making that benefits our communities and our planet.

I. Which of the following best describes your highest related level of education?

A. Master's plus additional coursework

II. you selected "degree and additional coursework" in question 1, how many additional upper division (300 level or higher) credit hours have you completed? Select the quarter/semester hours that best describes the coursework you have completed in addition to your degree. Do not include coursework taken as part of completing your degree. If you selected any other option, choose N/A.

A. 144-191 Quarter hours/96-127 Semester hours

III. If you selected "Other Related Degree" in question 4, please identify the focus of your degree or coursework. If you did not, enter N/A.

A. I earned a an MS in environmental chemistry and had upper division courses in theoretical and applied chemistry at that time. During my recent tenure at Portland State University I earned a Master's in Systems science and graduate certificates in sustainability and statistics. The foci of my additional coursework, in large measure in support of doctoral studies in the Earth, Environment, and Society program, included 1) research methods classes in ecosystem services and landscape ecology, 2) classes in data science and scientific inference, 3) computer-based simulation modeling as well as probability and statistical models for complex adaptive systems, and 3) general interest classes in science, grant writing, philosophy, and Spanish. The focus of my National Science Foundation (NSF) scholarship coursework, however, was on ecosystem services: the wise use of natural resources for maintaining long-term ecosystem functionality and resiliency.

IV. Which of the following best describes the focus of your degree?

A. Environmental science

V. f you selected "Other Related Degree" in question 5, please identify the focus of your degree. If you selected any other option, enter N/A.

A. N/A

- VI. Which of the following best describes your level of experience at a technical or professional level performing activities in a natural resource program such as researching and analyzing data, conducting investigations, applying pertinent laws and regulations, or coordinating and monitoring project activities?

A. 5 or more years

- VII. Which of the following best describes your length of experience working in or with regulatory programs affecting hazardous waste where your tasks included researching and analyzing data, conducting investigations applying pertinent laws and regulations?

A. 4 years

- VIII. Based on your answer to Question 7, please describe how you gained this experience and provide examples of the regulatory programs you have experience with. If you claimed no experience, please answer N/A.

A. I spent 4 years working as an environmental compliance specialist with Benchmark Environmental Corp. Our clients were nearly all DOE facilities (Los Alamos National Lab, Sandia National Lab, Idaho Engineering Lab, the Waste Isolation Pilot Plant) with responsibilities for managing hazardous and TRU mixed waste under RCRA.

- IX. Which of the following best describes your experience interpreting and presenting complex technical data to audiences not familiar with the material? If you have part-time work experience, please select the answer that is equivalent to full time

A. 5 years or more

- X. Based on your answer to Question 9, please describe how you gained this experience and provide examples of situations where you have interpreted and presented complex technical data to audiences not familiar with the material and the entities with which you communicated. If you do not have this type of experience, please enter N/A.

A. Working under NEPA with Marron and Assoc., I hosted public meetings to disperse information and entertain questions regarding environmental project effects. I regularly examined the regulatory requirements as well as the fate, transport, toxicology, and disposition of chemical pollutants and communicated those findings to clients and the general public. As a nearly 10 year veteran science teacher with Portland Public Schools I presented complex technical and scientific information to students from 6th to 12th grade.

- XI. Which of the following best describes your level of experience inspecting hazardous waste generators for compliance with RCRA or state hazardous waste requirements?
- A. 2 years
- XII. Based on your answer to Question 11, please describe how you obtained the above experience including your role and the types of generators you inspected (large, small, conditionally exempt, other)? If you do not have this type of experience, please enter N/A. TA-54 on Mesita del Buey was the site for hazardous waste processing at Los Alamos National Lab. The Lab's RCRA facility operating permit was focused at this site. I did tour and examine TA-54 quite a few times in support of waste characterization efforts and to correctly document procedures for subsequent production of SOPs. This is the only generating site I have reviewed.
- XIII. Which of the following best describes your experience representing an agency or organization in meetings with the public, industry and other government organizations? If you have part-time work experience, please select the answer that is equivalent to full time.
- A. 4 years
- XIV. Based on your answer to Question 13, please describe how you gained this experience and provide examples of meetings in which you represented an agency or organization. What was the topic of the meeting(s) and who were the attendees/audience? If you do not have this type of experience, please enter N/A.
- A. I represented DOE in meetings with the EPA regarding the No Migration Determination for the WIPP. I represented engineering firms contracted by the New Mexico Highway Dept. in public forums. I represented Portland Public Schools during public conferences. Most recently I represented Portland State University's IGERT program in the presentation of a study my colleague and I performed on the ecosystem services of the Clackamas River Basin. Our findings were delivered to a group of Clackamas River Basin stakeholders including members of the Clackamas River Basin Council.
- XV. Which of the following best describes your level of experience at a technical or professional level performing activities in a natural resource program regulating air, water, waste, tanks, asbestos, clean up or other environmental programs where your tasks included researching and analyzing data, conducting investigations, applying pertinent laws and regulations, or coordinating and monitoring project activities?
- A. 5 years or more
- XVI. Based on your answer to Question 15, please describe how you gained this experience and provide examples of the regulatory programs you have experience with. If you claimed no experience, please answer N/A.

- A. I spent nearly a decade as an environmental regulatory compliance specialist steeped in federal and state regulations. I know well how to research and apply regulatory intent to real-world situations when dealing with issues regarding hazardous waste, air quality, and water quality and discharge permits (under 40 CFR Subchapters C, D, I) as well as with chemicals (under 40 CFR Subchapters E and J). I regularly wrote responses to questions on environmental compliance from clients and the general public regarding hazardous and solid waste disposal, action limits for chemicals under RCRA and CERCLA and legal requirements under the Clean Water Act and the Clean Air Act. I evaluated recognized environmental conditions in conjunction with Phase I environmental site assessments and communicated those findings to the clients and the general public. I attended a three-day training entitled, Hazardous Waste Management Under the Resource Conservation and Recovery Act (RCRA) from the Environmental Resource Center.
- XVII. Which of the following best describes your experience inspecting businesses for compliance with air, water, waste, tanks, asbestos, clean up or other environmental state of federal program?
- A. less than 1 year
- XVIII. Related to your answer on the above Question 17, please describe how you obtained the above experience and what environmental requirements you were inspecting for (air, solid waste, water, asbestos, tanks, etc.). If you do not have this type of experience, please enter N/A.
- A. I have only inspected construction projects under NEPA for compliance with mitigation measures.
- XIX. Which of the following best describes your level of professional experience providing technical assistance regarding hazardous waste management to companies or the public?
- A. 5 or more years
- XX. Related to your answer on the above Question 19, please describe how you obtained the above experience and what types of businesses you advised. If you do not have this type of experience, please enter N/A.
- A. I evaluated the hazardous constituent source term potential from RCRA solid waste management units (SWMUs) undergoing environmental restoration at LANL's TA-54. I developed sampling and analysis plans for hazardous and low-level mixed wastes for personnel of LANL's Chemical and Mixed Waste Operations Section. The sampling and analysis documents served LANL personnel as practical supplements to the waste analysis plan in LANL's RCRA

facility operating permit. I wrote the portion of the position paper that defined DOE's RCRA compliance approach to the flammability requirements promulgated in EPA's No-Migration Determination. I determined whether various materials and waste stream were or were not to be classified as hazardous waste under RCRA. I participated in a working group and in technical discussions at a conference entitled, "Characterizing Heterogeneous Hazardous Wastes: Methods and Recommendations" at University of Nevada.

XXI. Which of the following best describes your knowledge and experience making regulatory compliance determinations and enforcement referrals for environmental programs?

A. 5 or more years

XXII. Related to your answer on the above Question 21, please describe how you obtained the above experience and what programs you worked in (air, asbestos, water, solid waste, tanks, etc.). Please describe your role in making the compliance determination and any resulting enforcement action. If you do not have this type of experience, please enter N/A.

A. Typical of cases where I helped clients with regulatory compliance are first, the determination of whether or not carbon filters from 55-gallon drums packed with TRU-mixed waste are considered hazardous waste. And second, the determination of whether or not permits are required for piping effluent from proposed construction dewatering and sewer line cleaning activities into the Red River. This determination involved evaluation of what constitutes the discharge of pollutants from a point source, as defined by NPDES (40 CFR § 122.2), what constitutes the potential discharge of dredged or fill material (33 CFR § 323.2(c)), and what constitutes both.

XXIII. Which of the following best describes your professional experience developing policies that interpret and apply federal RCRA rules or state hazardous waste rules.

A. 4 years

XXIV. Based on your answer to Question 23, please describe how you gained this experience and provide examples of meetings in which you represented an agency or organization. What was the topic of the meeting(s) and who were you meeting with? If you do not have this type of experience, please enter N/A.

A. My experience stems from work as an environmental regulatory compliance specialist supporting various DOE facilities. I developed recommended method detection limits, practical quantitation limits, and spiking amounts and designed an evaluation report format for the Mixed Waste Methods Laboratory (MWML) at Los Alamos National Laboratory. The MWML was tasked with

assessing the feasibility of using EPA SW-846 methods for analysis of TRU mixed waste. I designed a series of experiments for the Idaho National Engineering Laboratory to determine if theoretical methods can be used to predict flammability of headspace volatile organic compounds. I wrote sections on facility description, boundary conditions and process tolerance limits, waste shipment screening, quality assurance and quality control for the revised Waste Isolation Pilot Plant (WIPP) Waste Analysis Plan (WAP). I prepared the technical approach, including all physical chemistry calculations, for estimating the gas-phase, source term amounts of volatile organic compounds (VOCs) found in TRU mixed waste that is to be sent to the WIPP.

- XXV. Which of the following best describes your experience representing an agency or organization in meetings with the public, industry and other government organizations? If you have part-time work experience, please select the answer that is equivalent to full-time. /2 I have sometimes represented private consulting firms in meetings with the general public and government agencies such as the DOE and the US Army Corps of Engineers.
- XXVI. Based on your answer to Question 25, please describe how you gained this experience including what organization you worked for and what your responsibilities were. If you do not have this type of experience, please enter N/A.
- A. Working as an environmental regulatory compliance specialist for Benchmark Environmental Corp., I was responsible for project management on a host of projects that supported regulatory compliance with RCRA and DOE Orders. Working as an environmental regulatory compliance specialist with Marron and Associates, Inc., I was responsible for environmental assessments under NEPA. I have given dozens of presentations to audiences as diverse as the university scientific community; the City of Portland; attendees at the US International Association of Landscape Ecologists conference; attendees at the EcoDistricts Summit conference; children, young adults (grades 6-12) and their parents; and adults with special needs. In every case I represented either a private entity, a public entity, or a community organization such as the Richmond Neighborhood Association.
- XXVII. Please describe the project management tools you have used and how you managed your time to meet deadlines and complete high priority projects.
- A. I have extensive experience in program and project management and am meticulous about time management and deadlines. I have over a decade of experience in management as a consultant, an environmental regulatory compliance specialist, as a high school science teacher, and as a graduate student juggling a variety of commitments and deadlines. Recently as project manager and QAQC officer for the LANDIS-II software enhancement project I hired

and supervised a team of computer programmers, designed and developed algorithms for standardized workflows using readily available team productivity platforms such as Slack, Trello, and GitHub, and designed and developed QAQC protocols for tracking and testing software changes. Project progress was summarized in weekly reports to our client, the US Forest Service. I have provided effective written and oral communication materials to community stakeholders, to clients, and to the university community. Such materials have included project reports, information sharing documents, instructional materials, and many types of graphics all of which were delivered with the highest quality and on time. For example, I was contracted by the Oregon Environmental Council to write a white paper on reactive nitrogen in Oregon. I designed the *Victory Garden Plus!* program to promote food security in Portland's urban foodshed. I have been an editor for the Complexity Explorer Project, and I have served as a peer reviewer for many of my colleagues. I have taken a class in grant writing for nonprofits from the late, Micheal Wells and have written two major grant applications in response to requests for proposals from the National Science Foundation. In fact, I was awarded a National Science Foundation Integrative Graduate Education and Research Traineeship (IGERT) Fellowship for my scholarship. While an IGERT fellow my colleague and I investigated how the delivery of freshwater might be impacted by potential climate fueled changes in land use and land cover. The detailed 33-page report, which included hydrological modeling, was delivered on time.

All of these activities, especially managing a software upgrades project while a full-time doctoral student in the Earth, Environment, and Society program at Portland State required disciplined and well-prioritized time management.

- XXVIII. Transcripts: If you are using education (a degree or coursework) to qualify for this position, transcripts must be submitted for all required or related courses. Transcripts can be official or unofficial and may be submitted prior to interview (if selected). Transcripts must include (1) the name of the institution, (2) the degree received, (3) required courses completed with a passing grade, and (4) your name.